Spoken Tutorial on Understanding APIs

Module	Module 3: An introduction to Building
Episode	2. Understanding APIs
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is and its importance. 2. Explain the role of an API in connecting applications and AI models. 3. Describe how prompts and API keys facilitate API interactions. 4. Apply the concept of API interaction to understand how applications receive AI-generated responses.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• What an API is and why it matters • Analogy: API as a connector between requests and models • Prompts as inputs sent through APIs • API keys for authentication and access control • How applications send requests and receive AI-generated responses
Meta Tags	API, Application Programming Interface, AI, Python, Prompts, API keys, Authentication, Requests, Responses, Models, Software Development, API basics
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Python basics for API

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on Understanding APIs.
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is and its importance. • Explain the role of an API in connecting applications and AI models. • Describe how prompts and API keys facilitate API interactions. • Apply the concept of API interaction to understand how applications receive AI-generated responses.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have Python basics for API.

Illustration showing API as a waiter connecting a customer (application) to a kitchen (AI model).	What if I told you there's a secret language that apps use to talk to each other? That language is called an **API**, or **Application Programming Interface**. Think of an **API** as a helpful waiter in a restaurant. You, the customer, are an application. The kitchen is an **AI** model or another application. You tell the waiter your order, which is your request. The waiter takes your request to the kitchen. Then, the waiter brings back your food, which is the response. The **API** acts as that waiter, connecting different software. It helps applications send requests and get responses from models.
Illustration of a user typing a question or instruction (prompt) into a device, with an arrow pointing to an AI model.	How do you tell this 'waiter' what you want? You use something called a **prompt**. A **prompt** is like giving a specific instruction or question to the **AI** model. For example, asking an **AI** model to 'write a poem about the moon' is a **prompt**. You send this **prompt** through the **API**. The **AI** model then processes your **prompt**.
Illustration of an API key (like a digital ID card or key icon) granting access to a secure API gateway.	But how does the **API** know who you are and if you are allowed to ask for service? This is where **API keys** come in. An **API key** is a unique code, like a digital ID card. It helps authenticate you, proving you have permission to use the **API**. This ensures only authorized applications can access the service. **API keys** control access and keep your interactions secure.
Flowchart illustration detailing the interaction: Application -> Request (Prompt + API Key) -> API (Verification) -> AI Model (Processing) -> Response -> API -> Application.	With **prompts** and **API keys** in mind, let's see the full flow. First, your application creates a request. This request includes your **prompt** and your **API key**. The application sends this request to the **API**. The **API** receives it and verifies your **API key**. Then, it passes your **prompt** to the **AI** model. The **AI** model processes the **prompt** and generates a response. Finally, the **API** sends this **AI**-generated response back to your application. This is how applications get intelligent responses from **AI**.

Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We understood what an **API** is and its role as a connector. We saw how **prompts** are inputs for **AI** models. We also learned about **API keys** for secure access. Finally, we traced the full interaction flow between applications and **AI**.
Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Think about your favorite mobile app that uses **AI**. Identify a feature that likely uses an **API** to talk to an **AI** model. Describe what the **prompt** might be and what kind of response you would expect. Compare the results.
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